

RFP Response: Apex Systems

Executive Summary

Apex Systems proposes a modular, cloud-native platform architecture designed for high scalability and long-term maintainability, addressing the client's requirement for a resilient procurement automation system.

Proposed Solution & Architecture

Our architecture uses a microservices design with independent scaling of the ingestion, scoring, and reporting layers. Integrations are exposed via documented REST APIs with OAuth2, supporting both synchronous and event-driven consumption patterns.

The system is built for horizontal scalability using container orchestration, with load-tested throughput exceeding 500 requests/second at P95 latency under 200ms.

Timeline, Team Structure & Milestones

Delivery is organized into four phases across 16 weeks: Discovery (2 weeks), Core Build (8 weeks), Integration & Hardening (4 weeks), and Go-Live (2 weeks). A dedicated team of 6 (1 architect, 3 engineers, 1 QA, 1 PM) is staffed for the full engagement, with weekly milestone checkpoints and a documented risk log.

Security, Compliance & Risk Controls

Apex maintains SOC 2 Type II and ISO 27001 certifications. All data is encrypted at rest (AES-256) and in transit (TLS 1.3). Role-based access control, audit logging, and quarterly third-party penetration testing are standard. A named compliance officer is assigned to every engagement for auditability.

Support Model, Experience & References

24/7 tiered support (L1-L3) with a 1-hour SLA for critical incidents. Apex has delivered 3 comparable procurement-automation platforms for enterprise clients in the last 4 years, with references available on request.

Risks

Primary risk is the 16-week schedule being tight if client-side integration credentials are delayed beyond week 2; mitigation includes a buffer sprint.

Price Table

Item	Detail	Cost (USD)
Platform License	Annual, includes updates	58,000

Implementation	One-time, phases 1-4	42,000
Support (Year 1)	24/7 tiered, included Y1	0 (bundled)
Total (Year 1)	License + implementation	100,000